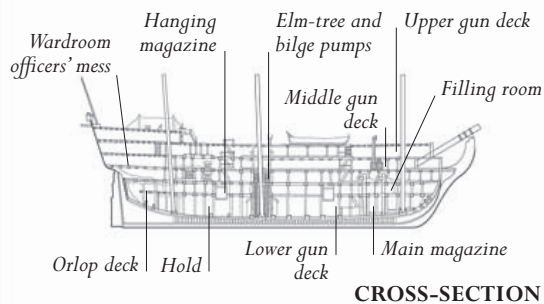


BELOW DECK

To keep the *Victory* stable, the heaviest guns – the 32-pounders – were positioned on the lower gun deck. The middle gun deck held the 24-pounders, while the 12-pounders were located on the upper gun deck. The orlop deck and hold, which were beneath the water line and safe from enemy fire, contained the magazines. The hold was also used for storage and ballast.

**▲ MESS TABLE**

The gun decks not only housed the guns but also served as living areas for most of the ship's crew and its complement of marines. Meals were taken at tables suspended between the guns.

GUN DECKS**► 32-POUNDER GUNS**

Each gun's recoil was controlled by a thick breeching rope. The rope allowed the gun to move back enough to be in-board of the gun port, so that the gunners could reload it via the muzzle.

► ELM-TREE PUMP

Two pumps made from elm trunks drew water up from the sea to fight fires and wash down the decks. They were operated from beside the mainmast on the lower gun deck. The *Victory* also had four chain pumps to remove bilge water or pump out water if the hull became holed (damaged).

**▲ SICK BERTH**

Sick or injured men were moved to a small area near the bow on the upper gun deck. In battle, they were taken below to the orlop deck, enabling the sick berth to become a functioning part of the gun deck.